

SCENARIO 2A: Homelessness and Rough Sleeping Charity

Module 2 Scenario | Charity Example

Organisation Overview

Organisation type	Local homelessness charity (outreach, emergency accommodation, resettlement and life skills)
Team size	Two people (services manager and comms and fundraising coordinator)
Volunteers	20 outreach and 10 hostel support
Funding	Local authority contract, grants and community fundraising

What this module teaches: Story structure (problem, belief, vision, invitation). The supporter journey from stranger to advocate. Inclusive formats. Meet people where they are.

This homelessness and rough sleeping scenario is a practical movement marketing strategy example designed for small fundraising teams who need to grow supporter engagement without large advertising budgets. The national community history programme proved that shared stories, told in the right spaces, build communities that sustain themselves. The same principle holds here.

Community-led marketing applies powerfully in this context. The volunteers, staff and people with lived experience who already believe in the work are the most credible and cost-effective channel available.

Authentic brand marketing for homelessness charities starts with one honest shift: stop leading with the problem and start leading with the belief. The Commemorative WWII Programme did not lead with loss. It led with pride, connection and belonging. This 30 day plan applies that same logic: build the story, map the supporter journey and amplify it.

The Belief



Everyone deserves a safe place and a path from crisis to stability.

Homelessness charities often lead with the problem, with statistics and suffering, but miss the belief, vision and invitation. The Movement Story template forces a shift from 'look how bad it is' to 'here is what we believe, here is the future we are building, here is how you join.'

Three Things to Keep Top of Mind

- 1

Telling people how terrible homelessness is does not build movements. Showing them the route from crisis to stability does.
- 2

The supporter journey is your roadmap. Without it you are hoping people figure out how to help. With it you are guiding them.
- 3

Anonymised stories told with dignity outperform statistics for donor conversion. Every time.

Week 1: Build the Movement Story

Day 1 to 2: Complete the Movement Story template.

Problem: 'In our town X people slept rough last year and most of them became invisible.'

Belief: 'Nobody is beyond help. Crisis is a moment, not an identity.'

Vision: 'A town where everyone has a safe place and a route to stability.'

Invitation: 'You can be part of the route. Not just the rescue.'

Day 3 to 4: Collect eight stories (consent led, anonymised where needed).

Four from people who have been supported ('what changed for me') and four from volunteers or staff ('why I show up').

Audio preferred.

Day 5 to 7: Create an inclusive Routes to Home Guide.

Three formats: print, PDF and audio. Not a service leaflet. A story guide showing the journey from crisis to stability, featuring real anonymised voices. Designed for library display racks and community centres.

Week 2: Map the Supporter Journey

Day 8 to 10: Complete the Supporter Journey Map template.

Awareness: 'I know homelessness exists.'

Understanding: 'I see the route from crisis to stability.'

First action: 'I attended, donated or shared.'

Repeat involvement: 'I volunteer monthly or give regularly.'

Advocacy: 'I bring others or speak publicly.'

For each stage: what the person thinks and feels, what proof they need and what the next step is.

Day 11 to 14: Design two pop-up story portals in everyday venues.

A library and a shopping centre. One table, the Routes to Home Guide, prompt cards ('What does home mean to you?') and a clear call to action: 'Come to our Story Evening next week.' This mirrors the museum's non-traditional venue approach.

Week 3: Bridge Two Communities Through Shared Story

Day 15 to 17: Host a Routes to Home Story Evening.

75 minutes in a community venue. Mix supporters and the wider public. One staff or volunteer story live, one supported person's story (video with consent or read by staff if anonymised) and one interactive element: attendees write 'what home means to me' on cards displayed on a community board. Light refreshments.

Day 18 to 21: Capture 10 reflections.

Publish as a story thread with careful safeguarding review. Ask every attendee to choose one action: donate monthly, volunteer, share or attend the next event.

Week 4: Sustain the Journey

Day 22 to 25: Launch the monthly Routes email.

One journey story (anonymised), one volunteer spotlight, one practical 'how your support helps' fact and one invitation.

Day 26 to 28: Partner locally.

Partner with one local employer or housing association. Co-promote the next Story Evening.

Day 29 to 30: Review signals.

Book the next event. Track journey progression: how many people moved from awareness to first action this month?



What Good Looks Like by Day 30

1

One Movement Story everyone can repeat without reading from a script.

2

One Supporter Journey Map showing the path from 'I care' to 'I am involved'.

3

One reusable Routes to Home Guide in three formats.

4

One Story Evening delivered with community reflections captured.

5

A shift from 'homelessness is terrible' to 'here is the route and you are part of it'.

Do not forget: The Supporter Journey Map is not a poster for your wall. It is a working tool you use every month. When someone donates, check the map. What is their next step? If you do not know, you will lose them.

Why This Saves You Money and Still Grows

Less waste, more reuse

The Routes to Home Guide and Story Evening become quarterly fixtures. No reinvention.

Partners distribute for you

Libraries, community centres and employers put your guide where people already are. Free and trusted.

Proof beats polish

Real volunteer stories and journey reflections outperform charity advertising.

Emotional truth converts

When someone attends a Story Evening, trust is built in 75 minutes.

How This Gets You More Donors

Awareness becomes involvement

The Story Evening creates an emotional connection. The monthly email sustains it.

Trust builds faster

Hearing real journeys, meeting volunteers and understanding the funding model removes the barriers.

Repeat loop

Monthly email plus quarterly Story Evening plus community venue guide distribution equals compounding community awareness.

Tracking: Non-Negotiable

Baseline (Day 0): Donor count, monthly income, volunteer enquiries and leading indicators (event RSVPs, guide take-ups and email signups). Review weekly for 15 minutes.

How a 30 Day Plan Becomes a Movement



A movement forms when 'everyone deserves a route' becomes a community identity people carry. They talk about it, bring friends to events and give regularly because they see progress, not just need. That builds donor resilience and reduces dependency on crisis-only fundraising.

Q: How does movement marketing work for a homelessness charity?

A: It shifts the charity from 'homelessness is terrible' to 'here is the route and you are part of it', building participation through Story Evenings, the Routes to Home Guide and a Supporter Journey Map that guides people from awareness to advocacy.

Q: What is community-led marketing for charities?

A: It means your volunteers, supporters and people with lived experience carry the message rather than the organisation broadcasting alone. When people hear a real journey story, they naturally tell others.

Q: Is authentic brand marketing different for homelessness charities?

A: Yes. The story structure is more critical here. Every claim must be tested against dignity, safeguarding and financial honesty before being communicated publicly.

Q: What is MUVIST Academy?

A: MUVIST Academy is a movement marketing education platform founded by Paula Lain and Marshall Gill, teaching SMEs and charities how to build community-led growth systems.

